

MJ (Maryana) Balezina

they/them

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EDUCATION

Aarhus University

Aarhus, Denmark

PhD in Political Science

Submitted in January 2026

- Dissertation title: Categorically (Trans)Fixed: Attitudes Towards Trans Inclusion in Sports
- Three-month research stay at Central European University; hosted by Prof. Dr. Erin Jenne
- Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Lars Thorup Larsen, lars@ps.au.dk; Dr. Nicholas Haas, nick.haas@ps.au.dk
- Affiliated with Centre for the Experimental-Philosophical Study of Discrimination (CEPDISC)

Central European University

Vienna, Austria

MA in Critical Gender Studies, with Merit

2021

- GPA: 3.65
- Thesis topic: Multifaceted bisexual subjectivity: narratives of bisexuals from Moscow, Russia
- Supervisors: Dr. Eszter Timar, Dr. Hadley Z. Renkin

HSE University

Moscow, Russia

BA in Psychology

2019

- GPA: 8.09 (max. 10.00)
- Thesis topic: Predictors for devaluation of women's bisexuality
- Minor in Sociology of culture
- One semester at George Mason University, USA as part of a Study Abroad program
- Supervisor: Dr. Elena Agadullina

PUBLICATIONS

Under review

- **Balezina** M. Trans* politics. In Z. Lefkofridi (Ed.), *Encyclopedia of Gender and Politics*. Edward Elgar Publishing Ltd
- **Balezina** M. Persuading or mobilizing? Priming effects of “sex” vs. “gender” on support for trans inclusion in sports. *Political Behavior*. [Pre-registration](#)
- **Balezina** M. Mind the gap: identifying differential support for inclusion of trans men and women. *European Journal of Politics and Gender*

Published

- **Balezina** M. (forthcoming in 2026). To each their sport: support for trans inclusion and fair play concerns. *Sexuality Research and Social Policy*
- **Balezina** M., Zakharova S. (2024). Measuring Attitudes Towards Rape in Russia: Translation and Validation of the Illinois Rape Myths Acceptance Scale. *Current Psychology*, doi: 10.1007/s12144-023-04666-2
- Agadullina E.R., Lovakov A.V., **Balezina** M., Gulevich O. A. (2022). Ambivalent sexism and violence towards women: a meta-analysis. *European Journal of Social Psychology*, doi: [10.1002/ejsp.2855](#)

Pre-print

- **Balezina** M., Agadullina E. (2022). Devaluation of women's bisexual identity: the role of gender, sexuality, and ambivalent sexism. WP BRP Series: Psychology. [Manuscript](#)

Manuscripts in progress

- **Balezina** M. Winners and losers of trans athlete inclusion: zero-sum views of sports policies

TEACHING

Aarhus University

April 2024 – Present

MA course instructor

Aarhus, Denmark

- **LGBTQ+ Politics: Identity, Rights and Advocacy**

Elective course on critical policy analysis and queer history at the Political Science department, 10 ECTS

- **Critical Media Analysis - Inequalities, Power Dynamics, and Identity**

Elective course on critical humanities and how it relates to journalism at the ERASMUS Journalism, Media and Globalisation program, 10 ECTS

HSE University

September 2021 – January 2023

BA & MA course instructor

Moscow, Russia

- **Social Psychology of Prejudice**

Elective MA course on discrimination and prejudice for non-Psychology major students

- **Social Psychology**

Mandatory BA introductory course at the Psychology department for second-year students

- **Psychology of Interpersonal Relationships**

Elective BA introductory course at the Psychology department for third-year students

BA thesis supervisor

- Effects of Gender-Neutral Language on Ostracism and Motivation
- Not So Different? The Perception of Bisexual and Homosexual People as Members of Separate Social Groups

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

September 2021 – January 2023

HSE University, Social Inequality Lab

Moscow, Russia

- Leading two student research groups
- Creating surveys and overseeing data collection
- Conducting quantitative data analysis in R (CFA, SEM)
- Preparing manuscripts for publication

Business Analyst

November 2021 – January 2023

ECOPSY Consulting

Moscow, Russia

- Preparing and uploading surveys
- Conducting quantitative (descriptive statistics, factor analysis) and qualitative (content analysis) data analysis in R and Excel
- Visualizing and interpreting results for client reports
- Providing survey support and client communication

METHODS TRAINING

Selected quantitative methodologies

- Survey Experiments
Training received at MethodsNet 2025 Summer School, *Designing Survey Experiments* course, taught by Dr. Christopher Wratil
- Measurement Validation
Full procedural cycle: translation, EFA/CFA, Multi-level CFA, battery dissemination
- Quantitative Text Analysis
Automatic parsing, DTM; word embeddings, topic modeling

Selected qualitative methodologies

- Semi-structured Interviews
- Foucauldian Discourse Analysis
- Critical Policy Analysis

Technical skills

- Data analysis and visualization in R
- Quantitative text analysis in Python
- Database management in SQL
- Other proficiencies: Excel, LaTeX

Selected conferences

- International Society of Political Psychology Meeting 2025, Prague, Czech Republic
Paper presentation: *Transgressing sex/gender: how frames affect support for trans inclusion in sports*
- European Political Science Association 2025, Madrid, Spain
Paper presentation: *To each their sport: support for trans* inclusion and fair play concerns*
- European Conference on Politics and Gender 2024, Ghent, Belgium
Two paper presentations: *Anti-Trans* Bills: Investigating Sports Bans* and *Fair and/but discriminatory? A case of trans* athletes*
- The Italian Political Science Association Conference (SISP) 2023, Genoa, Italy
Paper presentation: *Moral foundations in political debates on transgender laws: a comparative analysis of the US Senate and UK House of Commons*
- 17th European Congress of Psychology, 2022, Ljubljana, Slovenia
Online paper presentation: *People without rights: the role of dehumanization and threat in discrimination of homosexual individuals*

Schools

- Leadership Skills for Female Early-Career Researchers, 2022, University of York, UK
Two-week online course on academic leadership for Russian scholars sponsored by The Cultural and Education Section of the British Embassy in Moscow
- Diversity, Equality, and Inclusion, 2020, Free University, Russia
Six-week online course for selected students on theoretical and methodological approaches to DEI practices in academia and business

SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

Peer reviewing

Since 2024

- Current Psychology

Organizing academic events

Since 2022

- Conference panel at the European Conference on Politics and Gender 2024
Co-organizing two panels titled *Investigating Representation with QTA* and *Quantitative Text Analysis in Gender Representation: Methodological Insights from Parliamentary Speeches*
- Summer School *Academic skills for students in humanities* at Letnyaa Shkola 2022
Co-organizing one-week summer school for young scholars in humanities and social sciences; conducting six reading seminars on decolonial knowledge production for students of various academic backgrounds

Invited talks

Since 2023

- *Resistance to trans inclusion and fair play concern*
Aarhus University, 3 Minute Thesis Competition
- *Gender Inequality*
Aarhus University, Social Psychology of Inequality: Emotions, Relationships, and Groups
- *Trans* Legislation and Gender Fears*
HSE University, Gender Studies Minor
- *'Tolerant' West and 'Backward' East: How the EU is (not) Helping in the Fight Against Sexual Inequality in CEE*
HSE University, open lecture by Social Inequality Lab